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AGRICULTURAL SUPPLY CHAIN MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

RDBMS Lab Project Report

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Abstract

The Agricultural Supply Chain Management System is a comprehensive database-driven platform developed to provide an efficient, transparent, and user-friendly platform for tracking agricultural produce from farm harvest to consumer retail shelves. The project focuses on combining an interactive web interface with a relational database to manage supply-chain-related information efficiently.

The application provides features such as farmer harvest registration, cold storage monitoring, real-time logistics fleet dispatch, wholesale and retail distribution orders, and farm-to-table consumer traceability. Its modular interface and intuitive navigation make the different stages of the agricultural supply lifecycle easily accessible.

MySQL is used as the database management system to store and organize information related to farmers, crops, harvest batches, logistics transits, and retail orders. The database consists of five normalized tables and uses primary keys, foreign keys, and enumerated domain constraints to maintain data integrity and establish relationships between records.

The project demonstrates the practical application of database design, relational schema development, SQL DDL/DML, and client-server connectivity in building a database-driven supply chain portal. It also provides hands-on experience in integrating real-world logistical workflows with structured relational data management.

Overall, the project serves as an academic implementation of an agricultural supply chain management application while demonstrating fundamental concepts of relational database management systems and modern software development.

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Chapter 1
Introduction

1.1 Project Overview

The Agricultural Supply Chain Management System is an enterprise database application developed to provide stakeholders with a transparent and unified digital platform for tracking harvested agricultural commodities. The project focuses on implementing essential supply chain tracking functionalities along with relational database management.

The application is designed with a user-friendly interface and a structured relational database to manage information related to farmers, crops, harvest batches, transit logistics, and retail distribution. It demonstrates the practical application of database concepts and software development techniques in building a mission-critical agricultural application.

1.2 Objectives of the Project

The primary objectives of this project were as follows:

- To develop a simple and interactive supply chain management web and desktop interface.
- To design a normalized relational database for storing farmer, crop, batch, logistics, and retail records.
- To establish robust database connectivity using Java, JDBC, and RESTful APIs.
- To implement primary keys, foreign keys, and cascade rules to ensure data integrity.
- To model sequential supply chain stages: Harvested, Cold Storage, In Transit, Distributed, Retail Shelved, and Sold.
- To provide consumers with farm-to-table traceability through unique Batch IDs.
- To apply the theoretical concepts learned in Object-Oriented Programming and RDBMS.

1.3 Importance and Relevance

Agricultural supply networks are vital for national food security and economic sustainability. Post-harvest losses due to poor temperature tracking and middleman exploitation severely diminish agricultural profitability. This project provides practical experience in designing a database-driven system that ensures accountability, prevents food spoilage, and provides consumers with verified origin information. It also demonstrates how MySQL, Java, and Web technologies seamlessly integrate in production architectures.

1.4 Scope and Limitations

The current scope of the project encompasses digital farmer registration, crop batch management, cold-chain refrigerated transit recording, retail supermarket purchase orders, and consumer traceability lookups. The implementation is intended as an academic and functional prototype demonstrating robust relational database principles.

The project's limitations include simulated manual entries for IoT sensors rather than direct physical hardware telematics integration, and internal simulated billing rather than an active commercial banking payment gateway. Future iterations will consider incorporating automated IoT sensors and smart contract blockchain verification.

Chapter 2
System Design

2.1 Database Design Overview

The database of the Agricultural Supply Chain Management application is designed using MySQL, an industry-standard relational database management system. It stores and organizes information related to farmers, crops, batches, logistics, and retail orders.

The database consists of five tables: farmers, crops, batches, logistics, and retail_orders. Primary keys uniquely identify each record, while foreign keys establish relationships and enforce referential integrity with ON DELETE CASCADE constraints. Enumerated types (ENUM) constrain state transitions, preventing invalid logistical statuses.

2.2 Entity-Relationship (ER) Diagram

The Entity-Relationship (ER) diagram illustrates the core entities, attributes, and relationships within the database. The primary entities are Farmers, Crops, Batches, Logistics, and Retail Orders.

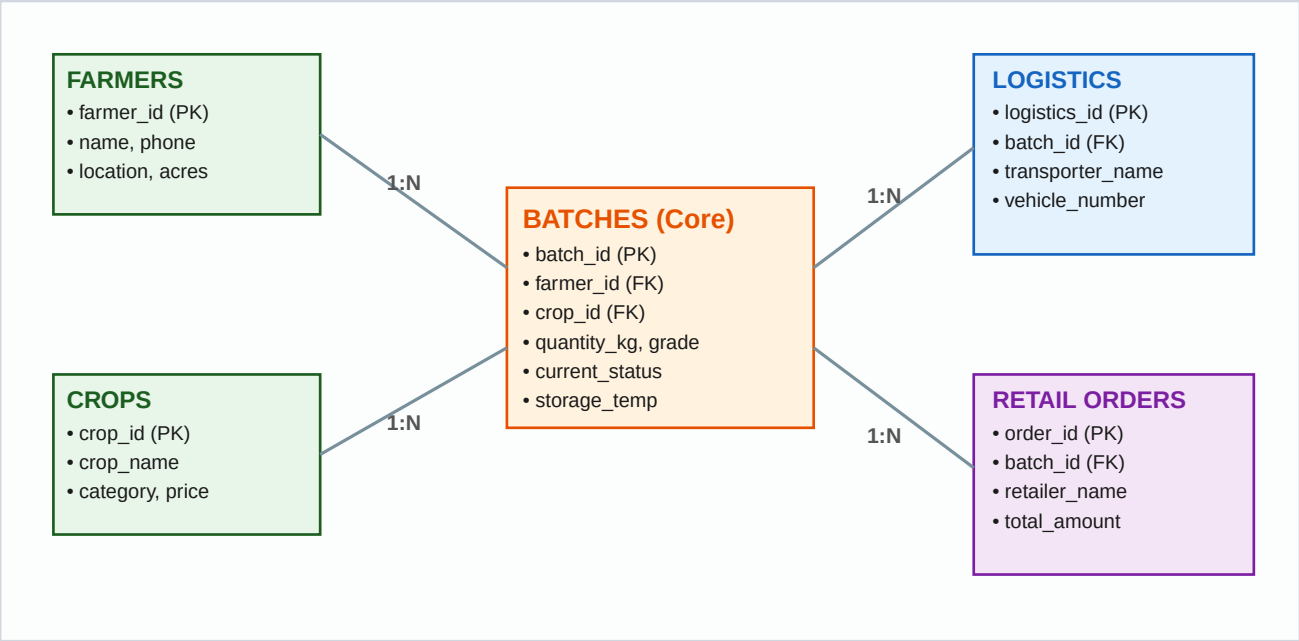

Figure 2.1: ER Diagram for the Agricultural Supply Chain System

2.3 Entity Relationships & Cardinalities

1. Farmers and Batches (1 : N)
A registered farmer can cultivate and harvest multiple batches of crops. Each batch originates from exactly one farmer. This is enforced by the farmer_id foreign key in the batches table referencing farmers(farmer_id).

2. Crops and Batches (1 : N)
A specific crop catalog item (such as Basmati Rice or Organic Wheat) categorizes multiple batches harvested across different regions. Enforced via crop_id in batches referencing crops(crop_id).

3. Batches and Logistics (1 : N)
A single batch can undergo multiple transportation legs (e.g. from farm gate to cold storage hub, and hub to wholesale terminal). Represented by the batch_id foreign key in the logistics table.

4. Batches and Retail Orders (1 : N)
A large harvest batch can be sold across multiple purchase orders to different supermarket retail chains. Enforced via batch_id in retail_orders referencing batches(batch_id).

2.4 Description of Tables and Attributes

Table 2.1: Farmers Table Schema

Field	Type	Key	Description
farmer_id	INT	PK	Unique identifier for each farmer (Auto Increment)
name	VARCHAR(100)	—	Full legal name of the producer
phone	VARCHAR(20)	—	Contact telephone number
location	VARCHAR(150)	—	Geographical farm location / District
farm_size_acres	DECIMAL(6,2)	—	Total cultivated land area in acres
created_at	TIMESTAMP	—	Record creation timestamp

Table 2.2: Crops Table Schema

Field	Type	Key	Description
crop_id	INT	PK	Unique identifier for crop type (Auto Increment)
crop_name	VARCHAR(100)	—	Name of crop (e.g. Basmati Rice, Wheat)
category	ENUM(...)	—	Grains, Vegetables, Fruits, Pulses, Spices
base_price_per_kg	DECIMAL(8,2)	—	Benchmark rate per kilogram (INR)

Table 2.3: Batches Table Schema (Core Unit)

Field	Type	Key	Description
batch_id	VARCHAR(50)	PK	Unique alphanumeric traceability code
farmer_id	INT	FK	References farmers(farmer_id)
crop_id	INT	FK	References crops(crop_id)
quantity_kg	DECIMAL(10,2)	—	Total harvested batch mass in kg
harvest_date	DATE	—	Date when crop was harvested
quality_grade	ENUM(...)	—	Grade A (Export), Grade B, Grade C
current_status	ENUM(...)	—	Harvested, Storage, Transit, Retail, Sold
storage_temp_celsius	DECIMAL(4,1)	—	Monitored storage temperature
created_at	TIMESTAMP	—	Timestamp of batch registration

Table 2.4: Logistics Table Schema

Field	Type	Key	Description
logistics_id	INT	PK	Unique shipment ID (Auto Increment)
batch_id	VARCHAR(50)	FK	References batches(batch_id)
transporter_name	VARCHAR(100)	—	Name of logistics provider / carrier
vehicle_number	VARCHAR(30)	—	Transport vehicle license registration
pickup_location	VARCHAR(150)	—	Origin farm gate / storage facility
drop_location	VARCHAR(150)	—	Destination market terminal / APMC
dispatch_date	DATE	—	Date fleet departed origin
transit_status	ENUM(...)	—	Scheduled, In Transit, Reached, Delayed

Table 2.5: Retail Orders Table Schema

Field	Type	Key	Description
order_id	INT	PK	Unique order ID (Auto Increment)
batch_id	VARCHAR(50)	FK	References batches(batch_id)
retailer_name	VARCHAR(120)	—	Purchasing supermarket / retail entity
retailer_city	VARCHAR(100)	—	City of destination retail outlet
quantity_ordered_kg	DECIMAL(10,2)	—	Purchased volume in kilograms
selling_price_per_kg	DECIMAL(8,2)	—	Selling price per kilogram
total_amount	DECIMAL(12,2)	—	Computed order revenue (INR)
order_status	ENUM(...)	—	Pending, Confirmed, Dispatched, Delivered

Chapter 3
Frontend Implementation and Features

3.1 Overview

The Agricultural Supply Chain Management System provides users with a centralized, responsive interface for managing and verifying agricultural products. The application replicates enterprise agricultural logistics systems while showcasing practical relational database integration.

The system employs a 3-tier architecture: the frontend client communicates with a native Node.js REST API layer that queries a persistent MySQL relational database. Concurrently, a standalone Java Desktop and JApplet client connects directly through JDBC to perform desktop-grade CRUD operations.

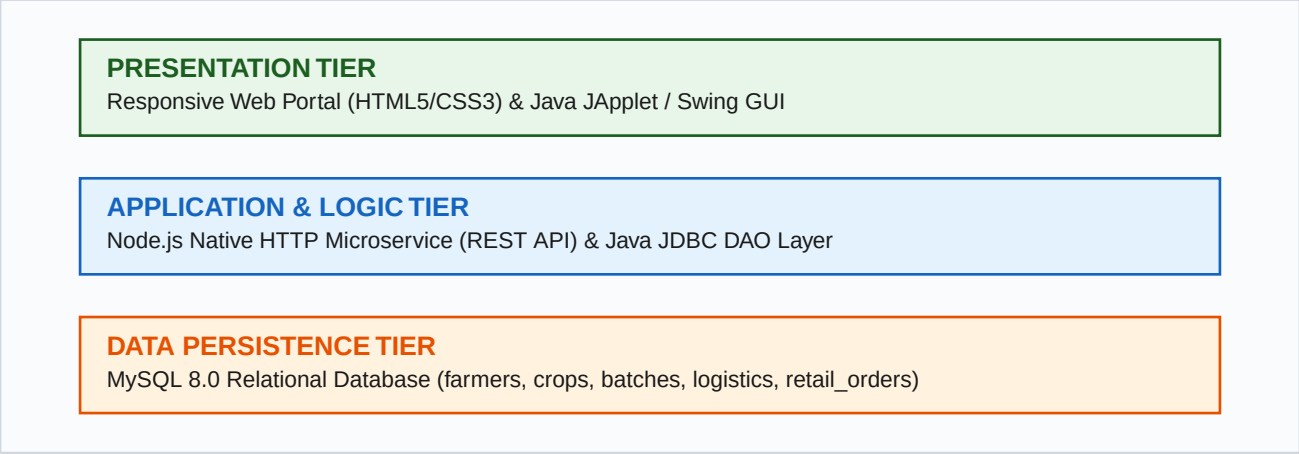

Figure 3.1: 3-Tier System Architecture Diagram

3.2 Live Supply Chain Operations Dashboard

The live dashboard serves as the central control room for supply chain supervisors. It aggregates live operational statistics into four metric cards and renders an interactive data table displaying all active batches in the supply stream.

Figure 3.2: Live Operations Dashboard – Inventory and KPI View

Each row is color-coded using CSS badges corresponding to the relational ENUM status. Users can trigger an instant traceability breakdown by clicking the Trace button on any row.

3.3 Farmer Harvest Registration Feature

The Farmer Harvest Registration module allows agricultural producers and mandi inspectors to log fresh harvest yields directly into the database. Every harvest is assigned an immutable Batch ID, linked to the registered farmer, categorized by crop type, and inspected for quality grade (Grade A Export, Grade B Domestic Premium, Grade C Standard Processing).

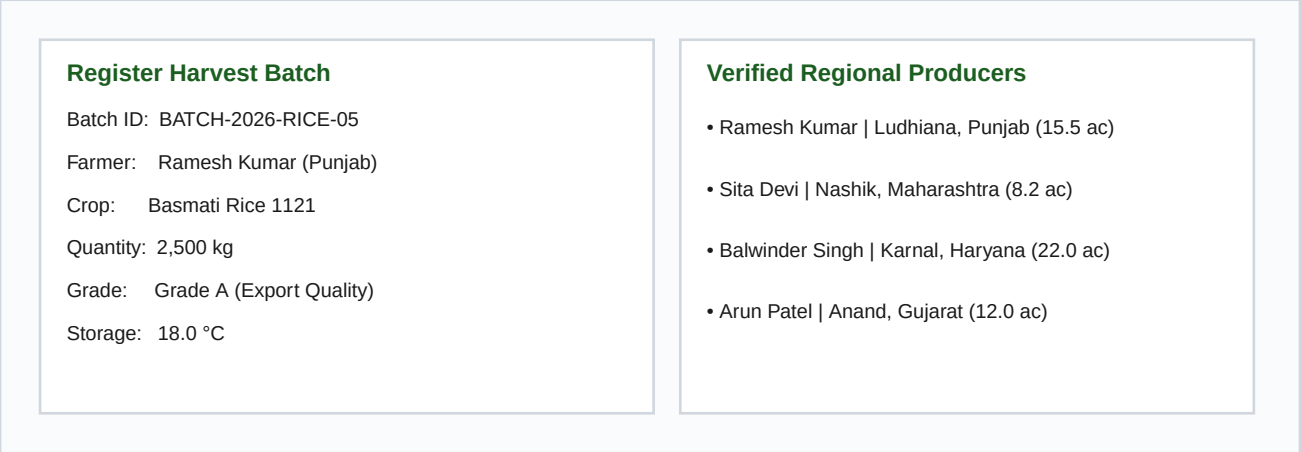

Figure 3.3: Farmer Harvest Registration and Producer Directory

Upon form submission, an HTTP POST request is sent to the /api/batches endpoint. The backend validates constraints and writes the record to persistent storage, instantly updating the global dashboard.

3.4 Cold Chain Logistics and Fleet Transit

Temperature abuse during transit causes rapid decay of perishable crops. The Cold Logistics module enables operators to dispatch refrigerated trucks, record the driver agency, vehicle registration plate, origin farm gate, destination wholesale APMC, and monitored temperature.

Dispatching a carrier automatically updates the relational batch state from 'Harvested' or 'Cold Storage' to 'In Transit', preventing double-dispatch anomalies.

3.5 Retail Hub and Supermarket Orders

The Retail Hub facilitates B2B commercial transactions between supply hubs and commercial supermarket chains (e.g. Nature Fresh, Daily Greens). Supermarket procurement managers select authenticated available batches, specify purchase volume (kg), and agree upon wholesale rates.

The system calculates total transaction amounts, logs the purchase record into the retail_orders table, and marks the batch status as 'Sold' or fulfilled upon confirmation.

3.6 Farm-to-Table Consumer Traceability Feature

The standout innovation of the system is the Farm-to-Table consumer traceability portal. When a consumer inputs a Batch ID or scans a product QR code, the system executes relational joins across five tables to render a verified vertical audit timeline.

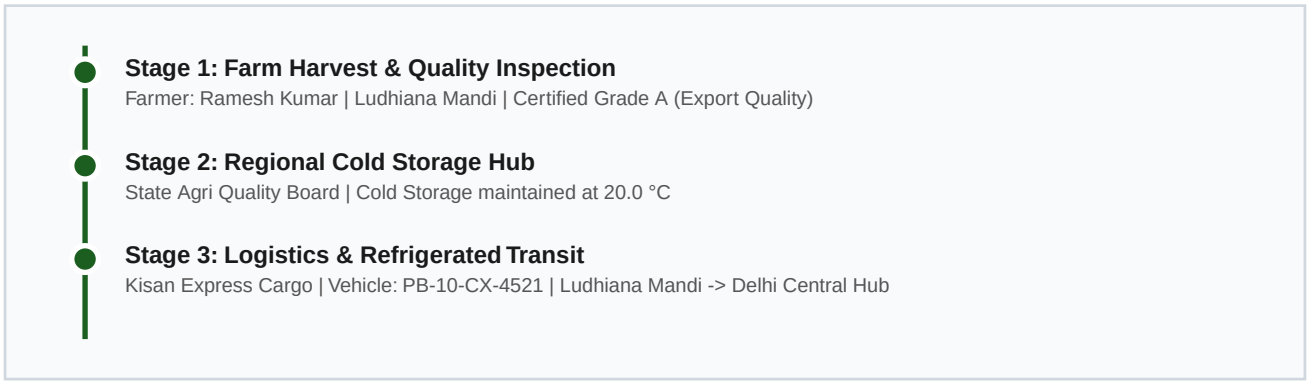

Figure 3.6: Farm-to-Table Verified Consumer Audit Timeline

3.7 Java Desktop & Applet JDBC Interface

To meet strict academic specifications, the project includes standalone Java classes (DBConnection.java and AgriSupplyChainApp.java). AgriSupplyChainApp extends JApplet with a main() launcher, offering tabbed forms for Harvest Registration, Inventory Tables, Logistics, and Traceability using pure JDBC PreparedStatement calls.

Chapter 4
Conclusion

4.1 Summary of Project Work

The Agricultural Supply Chain Management System project was developed to provide a robust, transparent, and user-friendly platform for managing agricultural logistics. The project successfully combines frontend web and Java development with relational database management using MySQL.

The application includes features such as harvest batch registration, cold chain temperature monitoring, transport route dispatching, retail order processing, and full consumer origin verification. The user interface is designed with a modern responsive theme and tabbed navigation for convenient access across operational stages.

The database was designed using MySQL and consists of five tables: Farmers, Crops, Batches, Logistics, and Retail Orders. Primary keys, foreign keys, and ENUM domain constraints were implemented to maintain data integrity and establish relationships between the tables.

Through this project, practical knowledge of database design, SQL queries, relational schema development, and frontend-to-backend connectivity was applied. The project demonstrates how relational database concepts can be integrated into an agricultural application to organize and manage supply chain information effectively.

4.2 Achievement of Project Objectives

The main objectives of the Agricultural Supply Chain Management System project were achieved by developing an interactive interface integrated with a relational database. The key objectives achieved are:

1. User-Friendly Interface: Developed a modern web interface with tab navigation for convenient access to different operational sections of the application.
2. Harvest & Crop Registration: Implemented structured forms for registering new harvest batches with quality grades and monitored temperatures.
3. Cold Chain Management: Integrated logistics dispatch functionality to monitor refrigerated carriers and transit routes.
4. Retail Hub: Provided procurement ordering workflows with dynamic revenue calculation.
5. Consumer Traceability: Built an instant multi-table relational query feature allowing consumers to verify product history by Batch ID.
6. Database Design & Integrity: Designed a 5-table MySQL schema utilizing primary keys, foreign keys, and cascade constraints to prevent data anomalies.
7. Java JDBC Connectivity: Implemented standalone Java classes to execute parameterized SQL statements via JDBC drivers.

4.3 Future Enhancements

While the current version of the Agricultural Supply Chain Management System successfully implements core database and logistics tracking features, several advanced enhancements are planned for future versions:

• IoT Hardware Telematics: Direct integration of GPS trackers and digital thermistors inside refrigerated cargo vehicles to stream live temperature data directly to the database via MQTT/HTTP protocols.

• Blockchain Audit Trail: Anchoring critical batch lifecycle transactions to an immutable distributed ledger (e.g. Ethereum or Hyperledger Fabric) to prevent retrospective record tampering.

• Dynamic QR Code Generation: Automated generation of printable GS1-standardized QR stickers for immediate scanning by consumer smartphones at retail checkout counters.

• Automated Payment Escrow: Integration of UPI and banking payment gateways to automatically disburse funds to farmers upon digital signature of receipt by retail buyers.

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